LOOP & BLOOM

Five-Point Star Granny Square — Free 10-Round Crochet Pattern

This Five-Point Star Granny Square combines a dense half-double-crochet center with layered shaping and a square border. The design begins in a magic ring, expands through carefully placed increases, and uses separate front- and back-loop sections to create dimension before the final border rounds are added. The pattern is suitable for advanced beginners who are comfortable working in joined rounds, increasing stitches, changing colors, and working into front or back loops only. The finished motif can be used for blankets, pillows, bunting, coasters, decorative panels, and other joined-square projects.



PROJECT INFORMATION

DIFFICULTY
Advanced Beginner

TIME
30–45 minutes

YARN
DK-weight yarn in 2 colors

HOOK
3.00 mm crochet hook

FINISHED SIZE
Approximately 3.54 × 3.54 inches

About This Pattern

This motif begins with a traditional circular crochet foundation. The first three rounds use half double crochet and regularly spaced increases to create a dense, flat center. Round 4 changes to double crochet and introduces a more complex increase arrangement.

The construction then uses the loops of Round 4 separately. One section works into the front loops, while another returns to the unused back loops. This layered approach adds structure and creates different surfaces without requiring separate pieces to be sewn together.

The final rounds use tall stitches near the corners and shorter stitches across the sides to convert the rounded motif into a square. A half-double-crochet border followed by a single-crochet border provides a clean edge that can be used for joining multiple motifs.

The sample is worked in DK yarn with a 3.00 mm hook and measures approximately 3.54 × 3.54 inches. The dense fabric and compact size make the square suitable for blankets, cushion panels, bunting, coasters, and decorative crochet projects.

Materials

- DK-weight yarn in 2 colors
- 3.00 mm crochet hook
- Darning or yarn needle
- Scissors

Abbreviations

- ch — Chain
- sc — Single crochet
- hdc — Half double crochet
- dc — Double crochet
- tr — Treble crochet
- sl st — Slip stitch
- st — Stitch
- sts — Stitches
- sp — Space
- inc — Increase
- rep — Repeat

- sk — Skip
- FLO — Front loop only
- FL — Front loop
- BLO — Back loop only
- BL — Back loop

Instructions

ROUND 1 — MAGIC RING CENTER

Pattern: Make a magic ring.

Ch 2, counting as the first hdc.

Work 7 hdc into the ring.

Pull the yarn tail firmly to close the center.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 2.

Step-by-step: Start with a magic ring and chain 2. The beginning ch 2 counts as the first half double crochet, so do not add an extra stitch to replace it.

Work seven more half double crochets directly into the ring. You should have eight stitches when the beginning chain is included.

Pull the starting tail until the center closes securely, then join to the top of the beginning ch 2 with a slip stitch.

Stitch count: 8 hdc.

ROUND 2 — DOUBLE THE CENTER

Pattern: Ch 2, counting as hdc.

Work another hdc in the same st to complete the first hdc inc.

Work 2 hdc in each remaining st around.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 2.

Step-by-step: Every stitch in this round receives two half double crochets.

The beginning ch 2 already counts as the first hdc in the first stitch. Work one more hdc into that same stitch to complete the first increase.

Continue working two hdc into every stitch around. This doubles the stitch count from 8 to 16 and expands the center evenly.

Stitch count: 16 hdc.

ROUND 3 — CONTINUE THE INCREASES

Pattern: Ch 2, counting as hdc.

Hdc inc in the next st.

Work [hdc in next st, hdc inc in next st] 7 times.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 2.

Step-by-step: This round spaces the increases farther apart.

The beginning ch 2 counts as the first regular hdc. Work two hdc in the following stitch to make an increase.

Continue alternating one regular half double crochet with one half-double-crochet increase around the circle.

When finished, the round should contain 24 stitches and remain flat rather than cupping or ruffling.

Stitch count: 24 hdc.

ROUND 4 — DOUBLE CROCHET INCREASE ROUND

Pattern: Ch 3, counting as dc.

Work another dc in the same st to form a dc inc.

Dc in the next st.

Dc inc in the next st.

Work [dc inc, dc, dc inc] 7 times.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 3.

Fasten off.

Pattern note: The source notes elsewhere that the increase placement creates the five-point star and refers to eight increases, but the written Round 4 sequence contains more increases than that. The written sequence above has been preserved exactly in structure and should be verified against the original visual instructions before publication.

Stitch count: 40 dc according to the written stitch sequence.

ROUND 5 — CHANGES FROM HALF DOUBLE CROCHET TO DOUBLE CROCHET.

Pattern: The beginning ch 3 counts as the first dc. Work another dc into the same stitch so the round begins with an increase.

Continue with one regular dc and another increase, then repeat the supplied increase sequence around.

Because the source contains conflicting information about the number and placement of increases in this round, count carefully and compare the finished shape with the original pattern photographs before continuing.

ROUND 6 — FRONT-LOOP SINGLE CROCHET LAYER

Pattern: Work this round in the front loops only.

Join the second color into the front loop of any st from Round 4.

Ch 1 as a standing stitch.

Sc in the same st.

Sc in each remaining st around.

Sl st to the first sc.

ROUND 7 — USES ONLY THE FRONT LOOPS OF ROUND 4.

Pattern: When looking at the top of a crochet stitch, you normally see two loops. For this round, insert the hook only through the loop closest to you.

Join the second color, chain 1, and work a single crochet into the same stitch. Continue with one single crochet in every remaining front loop around.

The unused back loops of Round 4 remain available for Round 6.

ROUND 8 — WORK INTO THE BACK LOOPS OF ROUND 4

Pattern: Work this round into the unused back loops of Round 4.

Join the second color into the BL of any st.

Ch 2, counting as hdc.

Hdc inc in the next st.

Hdc in each of the next 2 sts.

Hdc inc in the next st.

Work [hdc in next st, hdc inc in next st, hdc in each of next 2 sts, hdc inc in next st] 7 times.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 2.

Step-by-step: This round returns to Round 4 rather than working into Round 5.

Use the back loops that were left unused when Round 5 was worked through the front loops. This creates two separate layers emerging from the same base round.

The supplied sequence places two increases within each group. Follow the stitch order carefully so the shaping remains evenly distributed.

Stitch count: 48 hdc if Round 4 contains 40 stitches as indicated by the written Round 4 sequence.

ROUND 9 — SINGLE CROCHET EDGE

Pattern: Ch 1 as a standing stitch.

Sc in the same st.

Sc in each remaining st around.

Sl st to the first sc.

Fasten off.

Step-by-step: Work one single crochet into every stitch around the previous round.

This creates an even edge before the motif is transformed into a square. Keep your tension consistent so the edge stays flat.

Join to the first single crochet and fasten off.

STEP 10 — FIVE-POINT STAR MOTIF

Pattern: Work in the front loops of Round 4.

Join the second color into any appropriate st.

Ch 12.

Sk the next 15 sts.

Work [sl st in the following st, ch 12, sk 15 sts] 4 times.

Sl st to the first ch.

Fasten off.

Pattern note: The source separately identifies this as the Five-Point Star Motif and states that it is worked in the front loops of Round 4. However, Round 5 is also explicitly instructed to use the front loops of Round 4. The exact relationship and working order between Round 5 and this motif cannot be established safely from the supplied text alone. Verify this step against the original pattern images before publication.

Step-by-step: This separate motif section creates five long chain sections by chaining 12 and skipping 15 stitches between attachment points.

Those evenly spaced attachment points are intended to establish the five-part star structure.

Because the source assigns both this motif and Round 5 to the front loops of Round 4, the exact placement needs visual verification. Do not force the chains into loops that have already been occupied unless the original pattern photographs clearly show that construction.

ROUND 11 — FORM THE SQUARE CORNERS

Pattern: Join the contrasting color into any st.

Ch 4, counting as tr.

In the same st work:

tr, ch 3, 2 tr

Then work:

tr, 2 dc, 2 hdc, 3 sc, 2 hdc, 2 dc, tr

Work [2 tr, ch 3, 2 tr in next st, tr, 2 dc, 2 hdc, 3 sc, 2 hdc, 2 dc, tr] 3 times.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 4.

Fasten off.

ROUND 12 — BEGINS TRANSFORMING THE MOTIF INTO A SQUARE.

Pattern: Each corner is created with a group of four treble crochets separated by a ch-3 space. Between the corners, the stitch heights gradually move from tall treble crochets down through double and half double crochet to single crochet, then rise again.

This change in stitch height shapes each side while keeping the four corners prominent.

You should finish with four ch-3 corner spaces positioned around the motif.

ROUND 13 — HALF DOUBLE CROCHET BORDER

Pattern: Join the second color in any corner sp.

Ch 2, counting as hdc.

Work 1 more hdc in the same corner sp.

Ch 3.

Work 2 hdc in the same corner sp.

Hdc in each st along the side.

In every remaining corner sp work:

2 hdc, ch 3, 2 hdc

Continue working hdc in each st between corners.

Sl st to the top of the beginning ch 2.

Fasten off.

Step-by-step: Begin in any ch-3 corner from Round 8.

The first corner receives two hdc, ch 3, and two more hdc. This creates a strong corner while maintaining the square shape.

Work one half double crochet into every stitch along each side. Repeat the same corner group in all four corners.

Join to the beginning ch 2 and fasten off.

ROUND 14 — FINAL SINGLE CROCHET BORDER

Pattern: Join the contrasting color into any corner sp.

Ch 1 as a standing stitch.

Work 3 sc in the same corner sp.

Sc in each st along the side.

Work 3 sc in each remaining corner sp.

Continue with sc in each st around.

Sl st to the first sc.

Fasten off.

Step-by-step: The final round adds a simple single-crochet edge around the square.

Place three single crochets into each corner space. The extra stitches allow the border to turn each corner without pulling the square inward.

Work one single crochet into every stitch between the corners.

Join to the first sc and fasten off.

Finishing

Weave in all yarn tails securely on the wrong side of the motif.

Pay particular attention to the center magic-ring tail. Weave it through the back of several stitches in more than one direction so the center cannot loosen with handling.

Gently block the finished square. Shape the four outer corners evenly and, if the star construction has been confirmed from the original visual reference, arrange the five star points symmetrically before allowing the piece to dry.

Important Notes

- Remember that the beginning chains count as stitches. — The ch 2 at the beginning of the hdc rounds counts as the first half double crochet. Round 1 therefore contains 8 stitches when the beginning chain is included.
- Join into the top of the beginning chain. — When closing an hdc round, insert the hook into the top chain of the beginning ch 2 rather than into the space beside it. This creates a neater and firmer join.

- The 3.00 mm hook creates a firm fabric. — The pattern uses a relatively small hook for DK yarn. This produces a denser motif and helps the shaping remain defined. If your square is significantly larger than the sample, changing hook size is preferable to intentionally pulling every stitch tighter.
- Keep the color changes clean. — Complete the slip-stitch join before fastening off the old color. Join the next color separately at the specified location rather than carrying unused yarn across the back.
- Mark the beginning of joined rounds. — Place a stitch marker in the top of the beginning ch 2 or other starting stitch. This makes it easier to identify the correct joining point and prevents accidental extra stitches.
- Verify the front-loop star construction before publication. — The source assigns the front loops of Round 4 to both Round 5 and a separately described Five-Point Star Motif. The supplied text does not explain how those instructions interact. Confirm the working order and loop placement with the original visual pattern.

Variations

TWO-COLOR STAR SQUARE

Use one color for the inner motif and a strongly contrasting color for the star or border sections.

A light star against a dark background creates a celestial look, while softer combinations such as peach and cream or dusty rose and green produce a more subtle result.

MULTICOLOR VERSION

Change colors between selected completed rounds instead of limiting the motif to two shades.

Keep each color change at the end of a fully joined round so the transitions remain clean.

DIFFERENT YARN WEIGHT

The motif can be worked with another yarn weight and a hook appropriate for that yarn.

Heavier yarn will create a larger and thicker square, while lighter yarn will produce a smaller and more delicate motif. Make a test square before starting a multi-square project.

DECORATIVE STAR PROJECTS

A single finished square can be used as a coaster, appliqué, bag panel, or decorative patch. Several matching motifs can be joined for blankets, cushions, or bunting.

Common Mistakes

LEAVING THE MAGIC RING LOOSE

A visible hole remains in the middle of the motif, and the center may become larger with use or washing.

How to fix it: After working the beginning ch 2 and seven hdc into the magic ring, pull the starting tail firmly until the center closes.

Weave the tail securely through the back of the first-round stitches in more than one direction.

FORGETTING THAT THE BEGINNING CH 2 COUNTS AS A STITCH

The stitch count becomes incorrect from the first round onward, which can affect every later increase.

How to fix it: Treat the beginning ch 2 as stitch number one whenever the instructions say it counts as hdc.

JOINING INTO THE CHAIN SPACE INSTEAD OF THE TOP CHAIN

The join becomes loose and may create a visible gap or ladder-like line between rounds.

How to fix it: Insert the hook through the top of the beginning chain rather than into the larger gap beside it.

LOSING TRACK OF THE INCREASE SEQUENCE

The motif may begin to ruffle, cup, or become uneven because the increases are no longer positioned as instructed.

How to fix it: Use stitch markers to identify increase locations and count each round before continuing.

If the fabric ruffles noticeably, check for accidental extra increases. If it cups inward, check whether an increase was missed.

USING THE WRONG LOOP AFTER ROUND 4

The layered construction may disappear, or later sections may not have the required unused loops available.

How to fix it: Identify the front and back loops before inserting the hook. Round 6 explicitly works into the unused back loops of Round 4.

The source contains conflicting front-loop instructions for Round 5 and the separate star motif, so verify those sections visually before working them.

FAQ

IS THIS PATTERN SUITABLE FOR BEGINNERS?

It is best suited to an advanced beginner.

The basic stitches are straightforward, but the pattern also requires accurate stitch counting, increases, joined rounds, front- and back-loop work, color changes, and shaped corner sections.

WHY DOES THE PATTERN USE A 3.00 MM HOOK WITH DK YARN?

The smaller hook creates a firm, dense fabric. This helps the motif hold its shape and keeps the final square compact.

If you substitute a different hook, expect the finished measurement and fabric density to change.

WHY IS MY CENTER RUFFLING?

Ruffling usually indicates that the round contains more increases or stitches than intended.

Count the stitches and check each repeat against the written sequence before continuing.

WHY IS MY CENTER CUPPING INWARD?

Cupping can happen when an increase has been missed or when your tension is significantly tighter than the sample.

Check the stitch count first. If the count is correct, your individual tension or hook choice may be producing a firmer fabric.

CAN I USE DIFFERENT COLORS?

Yes. The motif supports color changes well because the rounds are joined individually.

Complete a round and its slip-stitch join before fastening off, then attach the new color at the starting point specified for the next section.

DO I NEED TO BLOCK THE FINISHED SQUARE?

Blocking is recommended, especially if you plan to join several squares.

Shape the outer corners evenly and allow the motif to dry in position. This helps multiple squares reach more consistent dimensions and makes joining easier.

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